Splunk4Ninjas - Dashboard Studio

Lab Guide

Overview

This lab guide contains the hands-on exercises for the Splunk4Ninjas - Dashboard Studio workshop. Before proceeding with these exercises, please ensure that you have a copy of the workshop slide deck, which will help to put into context the tasks you are carrying out.

Download the workshop slide deck: https://splk.it/S4NDS-Attendee

Prerequisites

In order to complete these exercises, you will need your own Splunk instance. Splunk's hands-on workshops are delivered via the Splunk Show portal and you will need a splunk.com account in order to access this.

If you don't already have a Splunk.com account, please create one here before proceeding with the rest of the workshop.

Prior to beginning this workshop, you should have either:

- Taken *Splunk4Rookies - Dashboard Studio*, or
- Have a basic understanding of - or have built a dashboard in - Dashboard Studio

You should already understand:

- How to navigate the editing UI and high level understanding of the source code
- How to add visualizations, searches, and inputs

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⚠️ Troubleshooting Connectivity

If you experience connectivity issues with accessing either your workshop environment or the event page, please try the following troubleshooting steps. If you still experience issues please reach out to the team running your workshop.

- **Use Google Chrome** (if you're not already)
- If the event page (i.e. *https://show.splunk.com/event/<eventID>*) didn't load when you clicked on the link, try **refreshing the page**
- **Disconnect from VPN** (if you're using one)
- **Clear your browser cache and restart your browser** (if using Google Chrome, go to: Settings > Privacy and security > Clear browsing data)
- **Try using private browsing mode** (e.g. Incognito in Google Chrome) to rule out any cache issues
- **Try using another computer** such as your personal computer - all you need is a web browser! Cloud platforms like AWS can often be blocked on corporate laptops.

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Exercise 1 – Set up your dashboard

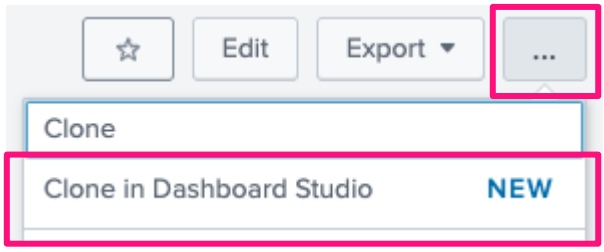
Description

Convert a Classic dashboard.

Steps

Convert a Classic dashboard

1. Log in to your Splunk environment using the **participant_x** user credentials provided, ensuring you replace ‘x’ with your unique User ID from Splunk Show. (e.g. If your User ID was ‘5’ then your username would be ‘participant_5’).
2. From the Dashboards tab, open the **Purchase Activity (Classic) dashboard**.
3. In the top right corner, under the three dots menu, select **Clone in Dashboard Studio**.



4. Provide a new title for your dashboard, such as “*Purchase Activity (Studio)*”
    a. (Optional) Specify a description
    b. Leave the Permissions as ‘Private’
5. Select **Absolute** layout

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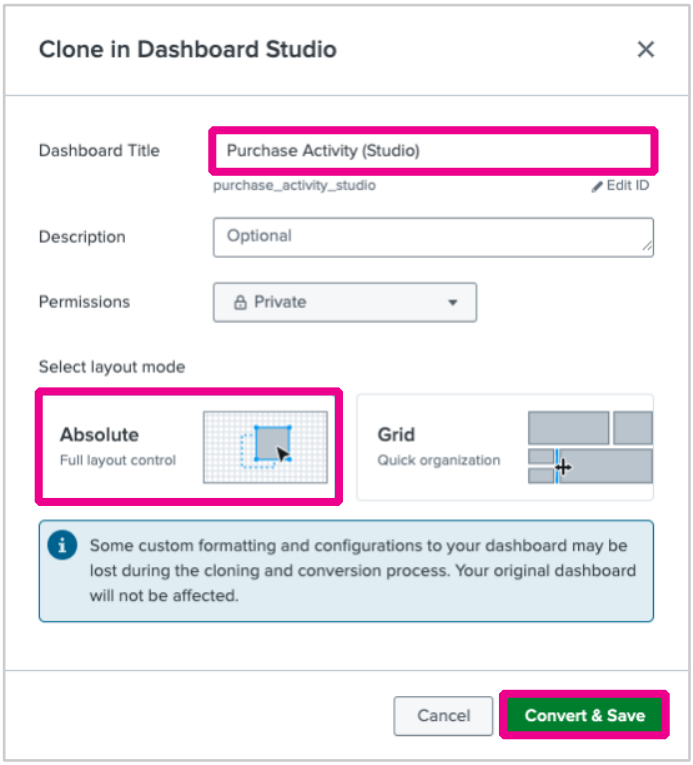
6. Select **Convert & Save**.



Note: Visualizations that extend beyond the canvas borders will not display in View mode. We will be rearranging these visualizations to all fit with the canvas by the end of this workshop.

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Exercise 2 – Configure product purchases single value visualizations

Description

Configure the 4 product purchases single values to have space for images (which we will add later) and to only take up the left two thirds of the canvas.

Steps

Resize product single values

1. Multi-select the single values

   On Mac: **CMD + click**

   On Mac + Windows: **Click and drag** to highlight the objects you want to select

2. In the right side configuration panel, bulk update all four single values to:

   a. width: **140**

   b. height: **140**

3. Deselect the four single values and select just one of them

   Under **Color and style**, change the **Background** color to **transparent**. Repeat with the other 3 single value visualizations.

Rearrange product single values

4. Add a rectangle:

   o. Set the **width to 250** and the **height to 140**

   p. Change the fill color to **white**

   q. Change the stroke color to **transparent**

5. Reposition the rectangle so that it's behind one of the single values with the single value on the left side of the rectangle, with empty space on the right

6. Use the layering icon to adjust which objects are in front or behind others

7. Clone the white rectangle three times, to place behind the other three single values

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Reposition product single values

8. Reposition your single values (and their white backgrounds) to take up the left two thirds of the canvas, and to have room for a text label above

Add custom label and divider

9. Add a Markdown component by selecting the 'M' ( ) icon in the toolbar

   In the right side configuration panel, add the following Markdown syntax:

   # Product sales
   Electronics sold by count and region

   Position the markdown above the single values. Note that the actual Markdown component won't update until you click outside of the configuration panel.

10. Add a rectangle to serve as a divider between the single values and map:

    o. Set the stroke color to **transparent**

    p. Set the radius to **10**

11. Position the rectangle to take up the space between the single values and the map. The width should be the same as the single values

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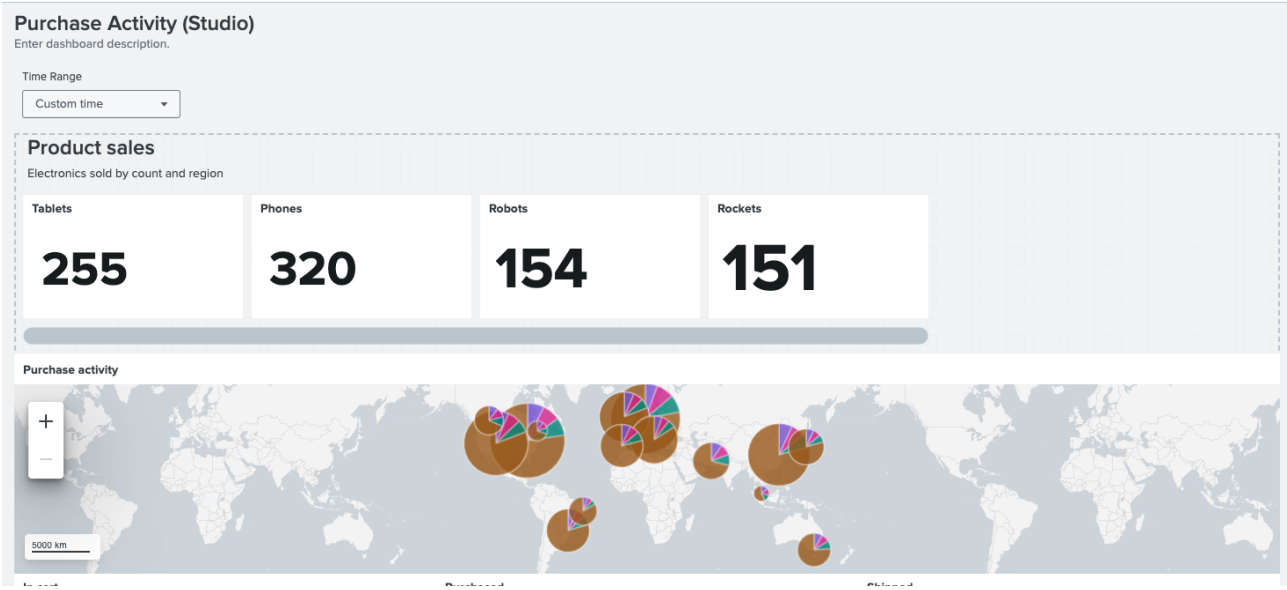


Update the single values to use one search

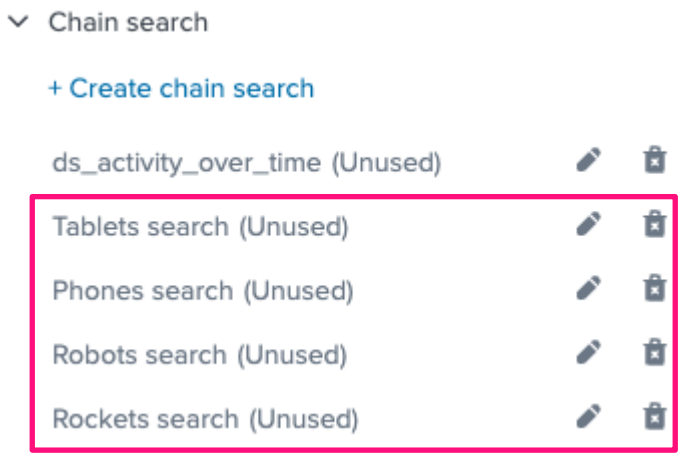
12. Select the Tablets single value and under **Data sources** click the crossed out pencil icon ( ) next to "Tablets search"
13. Select **"+ Set up primary data source"** and select **ds_purchases_by_product**
14. Under **Data configurations**, update the **Value** dropdown to select **Tablets (number).**

    Repeat the steps above for the other single values - Phones, Robots and Rockets - so that all four product KPIs now use just the ds_purchases_by_products search.

Delete the unused chain searches

15. Select the Data source icon the toolbar:
16. Under **Chain search**, notice that the Tablets search, Phones search, Robots search, and Rockets search all say "(Unused)"

    Clean up your dashboard by deleting these four chain searches. To do this click on the trash can icon ( ) next to each chain search.



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Exercise 3 – Customize the map and add a link graph

Description

Learn how to customize the map and configure a link graph to update based on what's selected in the map.

Steps

Resize and reposition the map

1. Resize the map width to match the divider width. Resize the map height to fill roughly half of the remaining vertical space (~300 px).

2. Move the map down to make room for a custom text label. You can move the other visualizations out of the way, off canvas for now. We'll add them back in later.

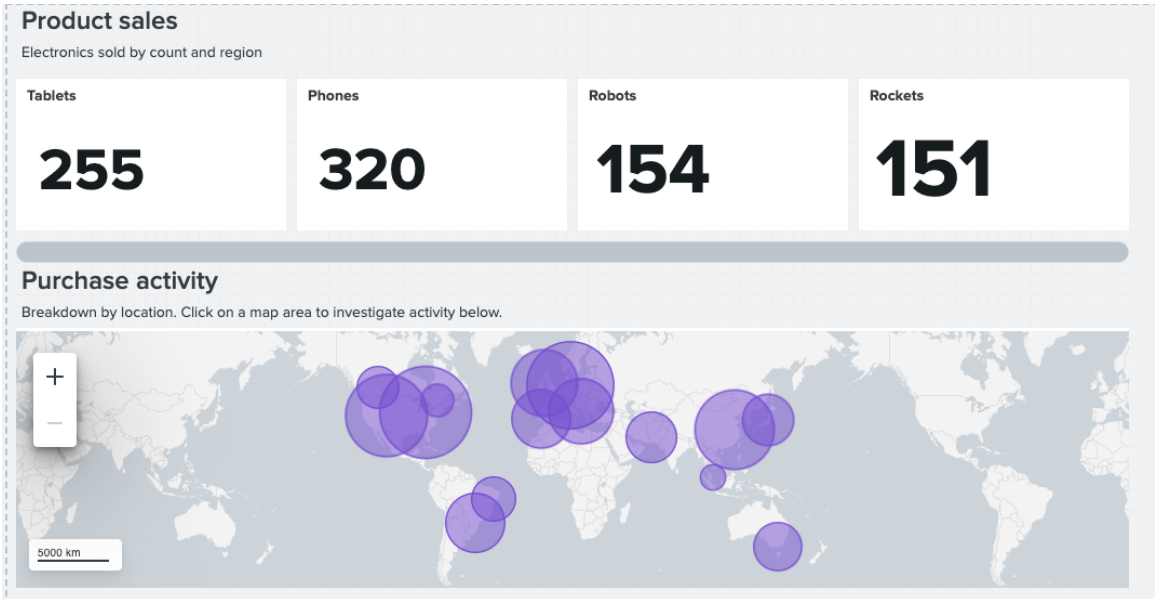
3. Add a Markdown component by selecting the **Markdown** ( ) icon in the toolbar. In the right side **Configuration** panel, add the following Markdown syntax:

   # Purchase activity
   Breakdown by location. Click on a map area to investigate activity below.

   Position the Markdown component above the map.

4. Remove the Purchase activity title on the map.

5. Under **Data configurations**, under **Bubble size,** deselect all fields except **products_purchased (number)**.



6. Under **Data configurations,** under **Additional tooltip fields,** select **credit_cards (number)** and **customers (number)**.

Add a custom tile server

7. Under **Color and style**, configure the following:

   a. Set **Base layer tile server** to https://tile.openstreetmap.org/{z}/{x}/{y}.png

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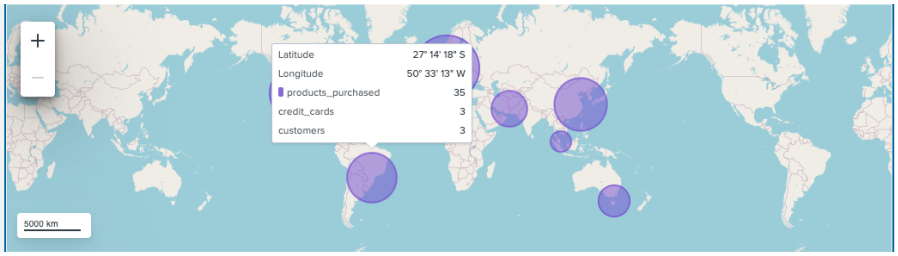
b. Set **Base layer tile server type** to **Raster.**

Your map should now look like this in **View** mode:



Set tokens on click

8. In **Edit** mode, select the map. Under **Interactions,** click **+ Add interaction.** From the dropdown, select **Set tokens.**

9. Specify the following 4 predefined tokens:

   - Token name: **mapBoundsEast**
     Token value: **row._geo_bounds_east.value**
   - Token name: **mapBoundsWest**
     Token value: **row._geo_bounds_west.value**
   - Token name: **mapBoundsSouth**
     Token value: **row._geo_bounds_south.value**
   - Token name: **mapBoundsNorth**
     Token value: **row._geo_bounds_north.value**

   Alternatively, copy and paste this directly into the source code, at the same level as "options":

```
"eventHandlers": [
        {
                "type": "drilldown.setToken",
                "options": {
                        "tokens": [
                                {
                                        "token": "mapBoundsNorth",
                                        "key": "row._geo_bounds_north.value"
                                },
                                {
                                        "token": "mapBoundsEast",
                                        "key": "row._geo_bounds_east.value"
                                },
                                {
                                        "token": "mapBoundsSouth",
                                        "key": "row._geo_bounds_south.value"
                                },
                                {
                                        "token": "mapBoundsWest",
                                        "key": "row._geo_bounds_west.value"
                                }
                        ]
                }
        }
],
```

Add a link graph

10. Click the Add Chart icon ( ) in the menu bar and add a **Link graph**. Position and size the link graph it to fill the space beneath the map

11. Create a new search for your link graph:

    a. Name: **Activity in a highlighted area**

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b. SPL:

```
index=purchases status=purchased
| iplocation ip_address
| where (lat>=$mapBoundsSouth$ and lat<=$mapBoundsNorth$)
  and (lon>=$mapBoundsWest$ and lon<=$mapBoundsEast$)
| table customer_id ip_address credit_card
  billing_address status
```

c. Click **Apply and close.**

12. Under **Visibility**, select **When data is unavailable, hide element.**

13. Click **Save** and go to **View** mode for your dashboard.

    Your link graph does not display because the tokens needed for its search are not set. Click a bubble on the map to see the link graph appear.

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Exercise 4 – Set up the conversion funnel

Description

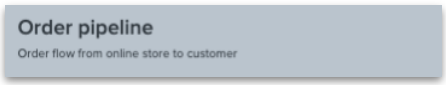
Set up a conversion funnel.

Steps

Create a section for the conversion funnel

1. Add a rectangle to fill the empty space on the right side of the dashboard canvas.
2. Set the stroke color to **transparent.**
3. In the right-side **Configuration** panel, add the following Markdown syntax:

   # Order pipeline
   Order flow from online store to customer

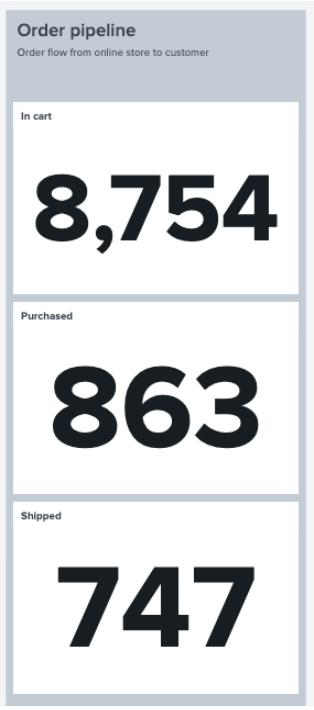


Place the order status KPIs

4. Towards the top of the conversion funnel, place the **In cart** single value KPI. Leave space between the Markdown and the **In cart** single value for a button and multiselect input that we will add later.

   In the middle, place the "**Purchased**" single value KPI.

   At the bottom, place the "**Shipped**" single value KPI.



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Note: These are the 3 single values that were originally at the bottom of the dashboard.

Set up an alternative "Details" view

5. Click the source code ( ) button to access the dashboard definition source code.

6. Add an expressions stanza with eval expressions:

```
"expressions": {
        "eval": {
                "expr_1": {
                        "name": "detailsBtnLabel",
                        "value": "$detailsVisibility$ = 'true' ? 'Show overview' : 'Show details'"
                },
                "expr_2": {

                        "name" "toggleDetails",
                        "value": "$detailsVisibility$ = 'true' ? 'false' : 'true'"
                        }
                }
},
```

7. Click **Apply and close**.

8. Add a button:

   a. From the inputs dropdown, click **Button**.
   b. Under **Display**, select **In canvas**.
   c. Position above the **In cart** single value visualization.
   d. For **Label**, enter **$eval:detailsBtnLabel$**.
   e. Under **Interactions**, click **Add interaction**.
   f. From the **On click** dropdown, select **Set tokens**.
   g. Configure the following token:
      - **Token name**: detailsVisibility
      - **Token value**: $eval:toggleDetails$
   h. Click **Apply,** then click the button to test out that its label changes from **Show details** to **Show overview** and vice-versa.

9. Place the "Purchased orders details" table over the "Purchased" single value

10. Place the "Shipped orders" chart over the "Shipped" single value

11. Navigate to the Data source overview panel. Select the pencil icon next to **ds_order_pipeline** and check the box that says "**Access search results or metadata**"

    Click on **Apply and close.**

12. Select the "Purchased orders details" table and update the title to **$ds_order_pipeline:result.purchased$ purchased**

13. Select the "Shipped orders" line chart and update the title to **$ds_order_pipeline:result.shipped$ shipped**

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Note: Once visualizations are layered on top of each other, you will not be able to focus on visualizations lower in the stack. You will need to move the upper layers out of the way temporarily, then move them back into position when you're done making edits.

Exercise 5 – Set up advanced conditional visibility

Description

Add a multiselect that allows the user to filter the visualizations in the Order pipeline by order status. Configure conditions so that, for example, if the user selects only In cart and Shipped from the multiselect,

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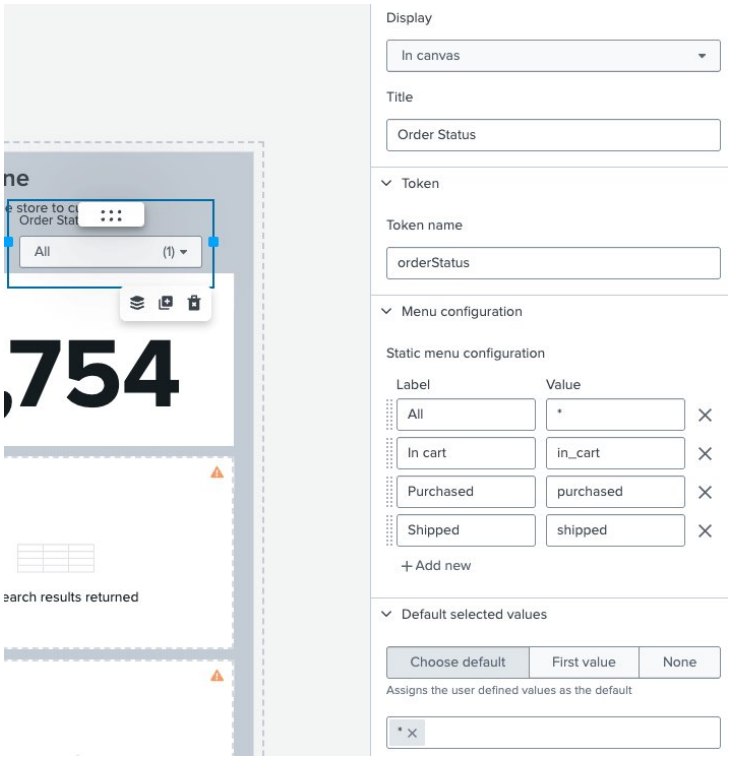
the Purchased visualizations are hidden. Configure a condition that shows the detail or overview charts based on the button status.

Steps

Create a multiselect input

1. From the inputs dropdown, select **Multiselect**.
2. From the **Display** dropdown, select **In canvas**.
3. Drag the multiselect beside the **Show overview/details** button.
4. In the **Title** field, enter **Order Status**.
5. In the **Token name** field, enter **orderStatus**.
6. Under **Menu configuration**, add the following items:
    - **Label**: All, **Value**: *
    - **Label**: In cart, **Value**: in_cart
    - **Label**: Purchased, **Value**: purchased
    - **Label**: Shipped, **Value**: shipped
7. Configure * as the only default value.



Configure the hide in cart condition

8. For the In cart visualization, under **Visibility > Custom visibility conditions**, click **+ Set up condition**.
9. Click **Create condition**.
10. Set the **Condition name** as "hide in cart".
11. The In cart visualization should be hidden when the user has not selected **All** or **In cart** from the multiselect. Add the following conditional statements, and ensure **AND** is selected so that the condition requires that both statements be fulfilled:
    - in_cart NOT IN $orderStatus$
    - * NOT IN $orderStatus$

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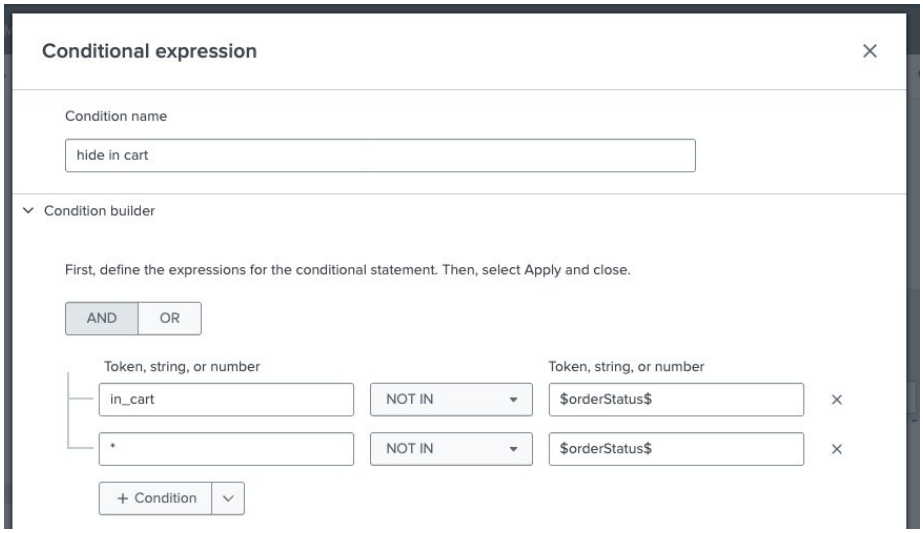
The second condition is for when the user selects **All** from the multiselect and $orderStatus$ is equal to *.



12. Click **Apply and close**.
13. Click the eye icon so that it is crossed out. This means that when the condition is met, the panel will be hidden.

Configure the hide purchased condition

14. For the Purchased table under **Visibility > Custom visibility conditions**, click **+ Set up condition**.
15. Click **Create condition**.
16. Set the **Condition name** as "hide purchased".
17. The Purchased table should be hidden when the user has not selected **All** or **Purchased** from the multiselect. Add the following conditional statements, and ensure **AND** is selected so that the condition requires that both statements be fulfilled:
    - purchased NOT IN $orderStatus$
    - * NOT IN $orderStatus$

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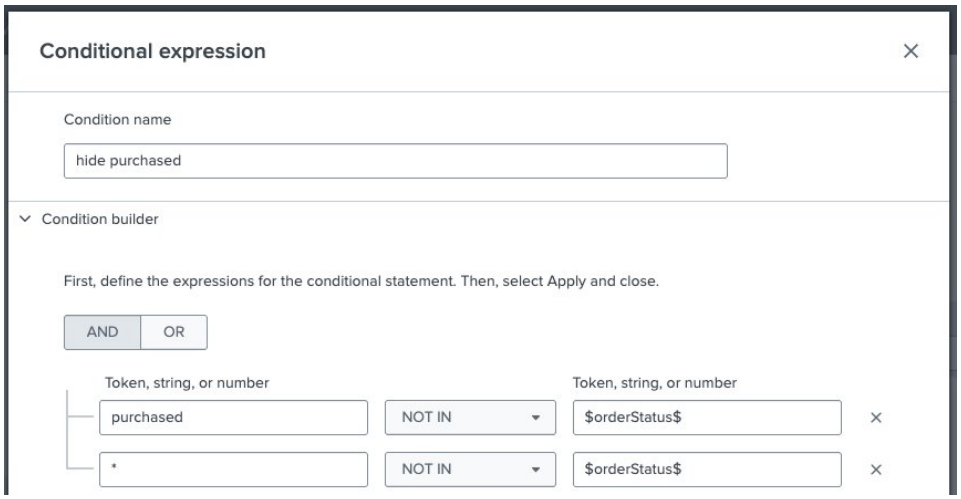
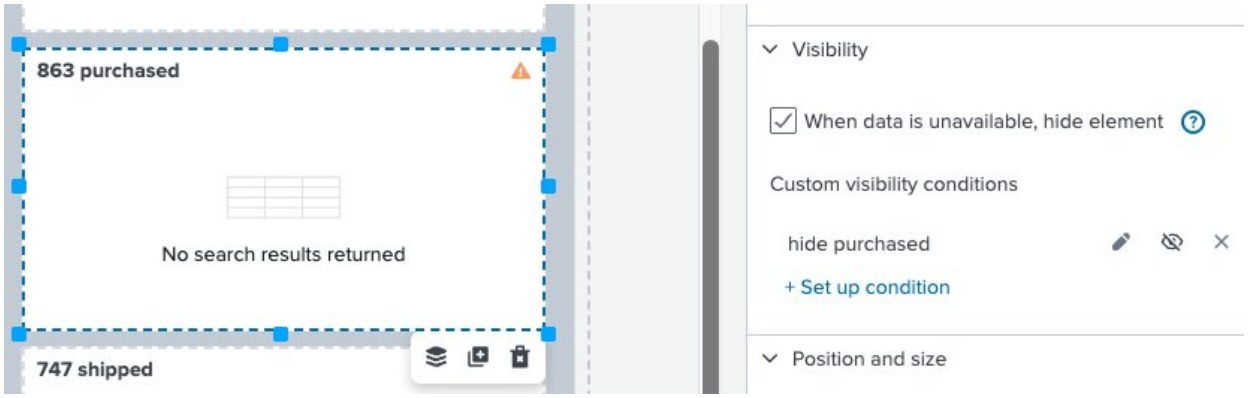
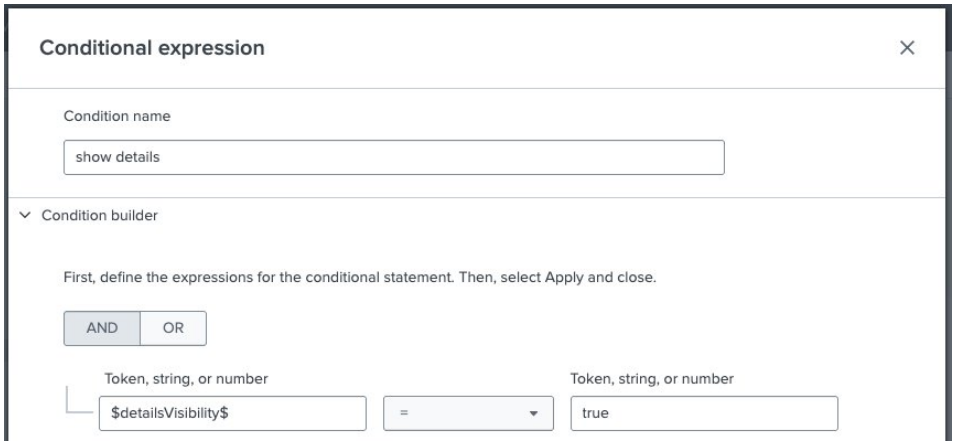


18. Click **Apply and close**.
19. Click the eye icon so that it is crossed out. This means that when the condition is met, the panel will be hidden.



Configure the show details condition

20. For the Purchased table under **Visibility > Custom visibility conditions**, click **+ Set up condition**.
21. Click **Create condition**.
22. Set the **Condition name** as "show details".
23. The Purchased table should display when the user has clicked the button to show details. Add the following conditional statement:
    - $detailsVisibility$=true



24. Click **Apply and close**.

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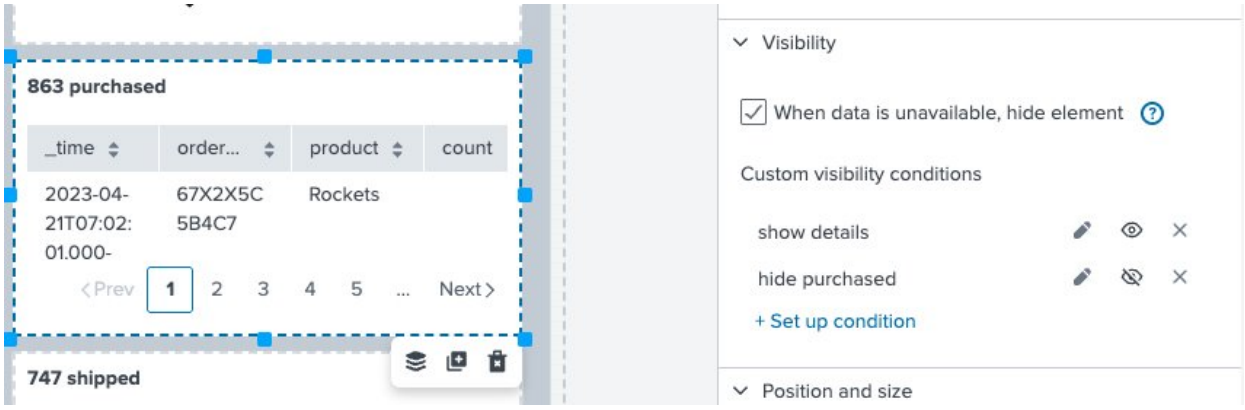
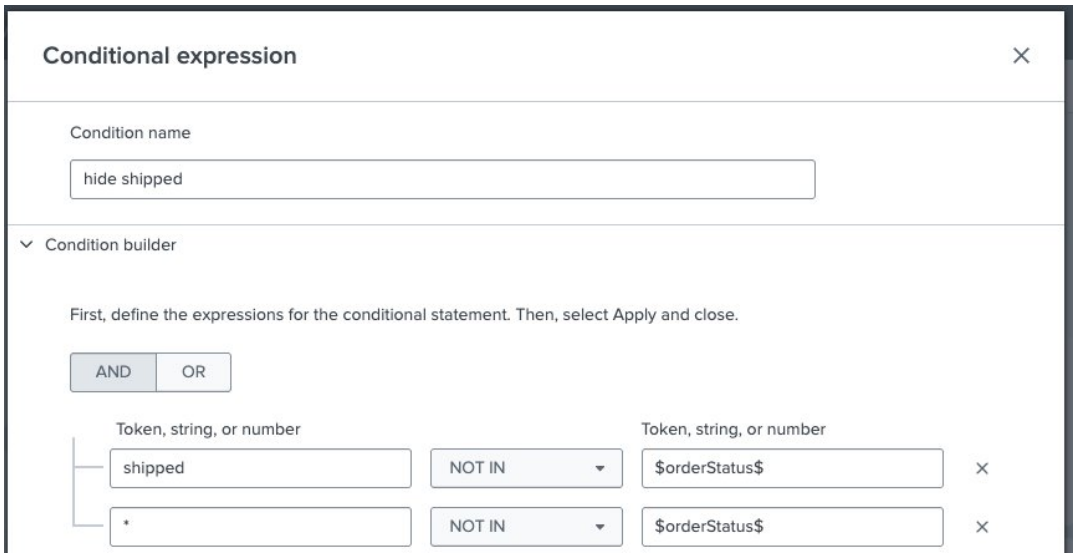
25. Leave the eye icon so that it is not crossed out. This means that when the condition is met, the panel will display.

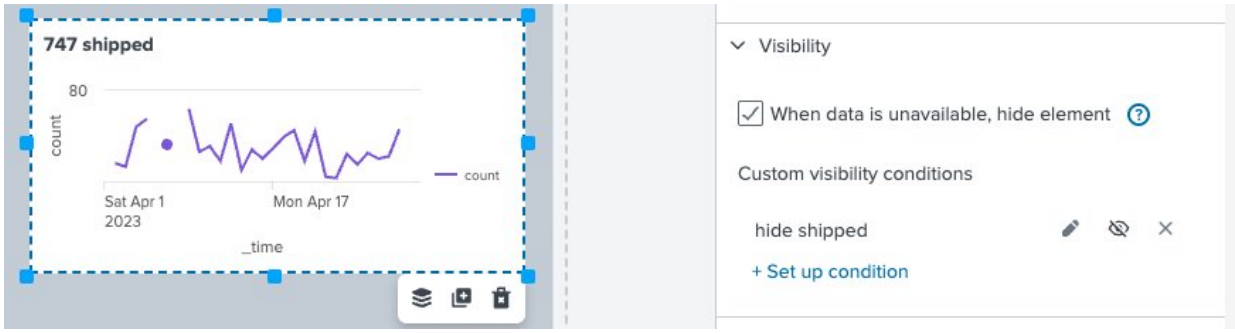


Configure the hide shipped condition

26. For the Purchased table under **Visibility > Custom visibility conditions**, click **+ Set up condition**.
27. Click **Create condition**.
28. Set the **Condition name** as "hide shipped".
29. The Shipped line chart should be hidden when the user has not selected **All** or **Shipped** from the multiselect. Add the following conditional statements, and ensure **AND** is selected so that the condition requires that both statements be fulfilled:
    - shipped NOT IN $orderStatus$
    - * NOT IN $orderStatus$



30. Click **Apply and close**.
31. Click the eye icon so that it is crossed out. This means that when the condition is met, the panel will be hidden.



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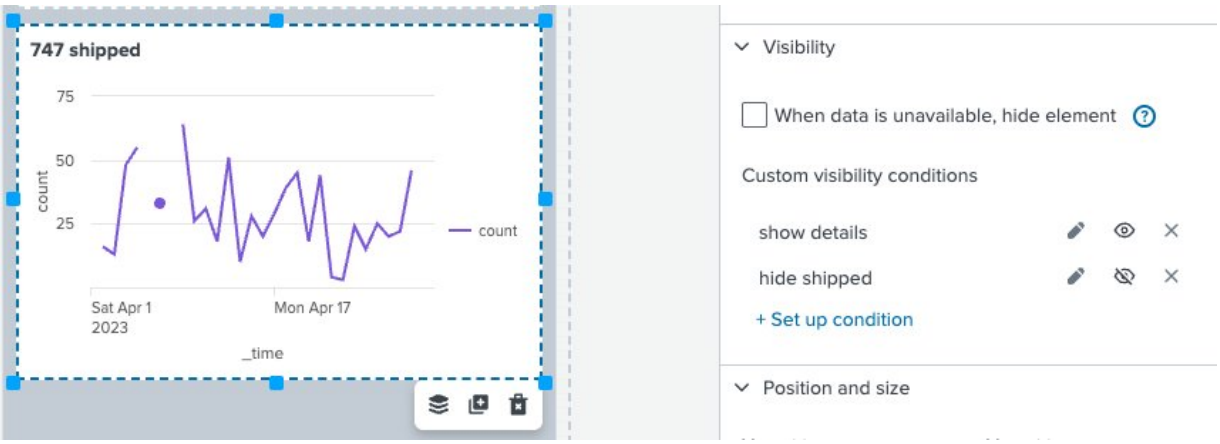
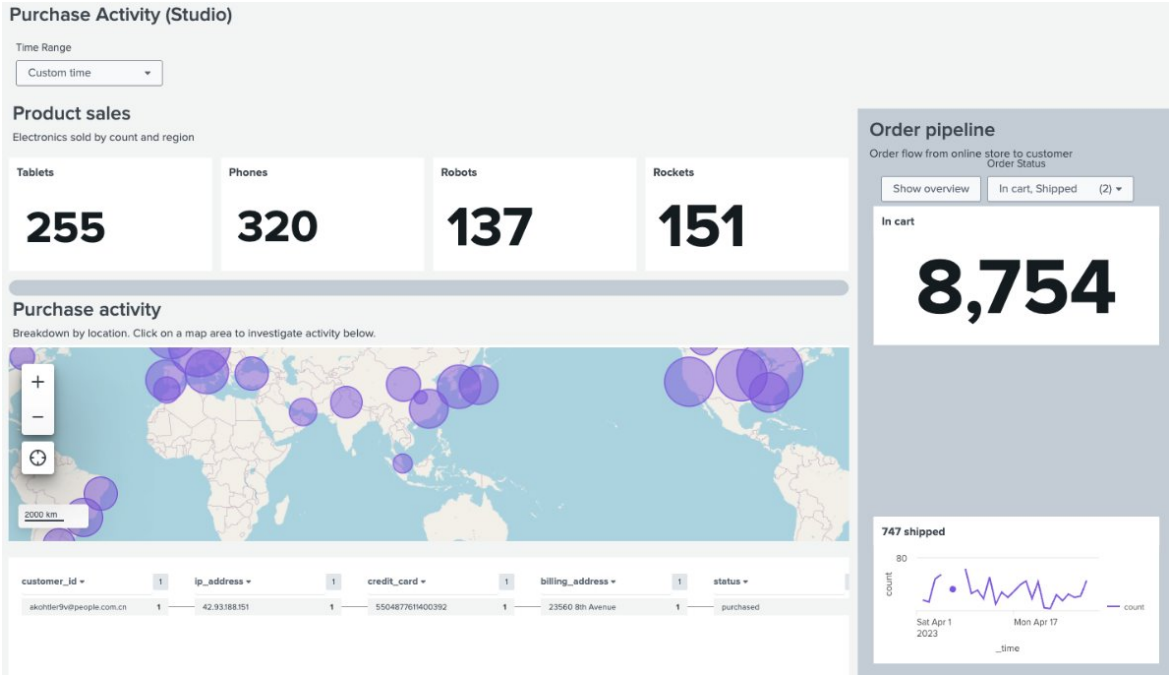
Apply visibility conditions

32. Select the **Shipped** line chart, then under **Visibility**, select **+ Set up condition.**
33. Select the **show details** condition that we created earlier.
34. Leave the eye icon so that it is not crossed out.



35. Select the **Purchased** single value visualization, then under **Visibility**, select **+ Set up condition.**
36. Select the **hide purchased** condition that we created earlier.
37. Click the eye icon so that it is crossed out.
38. Select the **Shipped** single value visualization, then under **Visibility**, select **+ Set up condition.**
39. Select the **hide shipped** condition that we created earlier.
40. Click the eye icon so that it is crossed out.
41. Go to **View** mode and switch between the overview and details views and different selections in the **Order Status** multiselect to test visibility.



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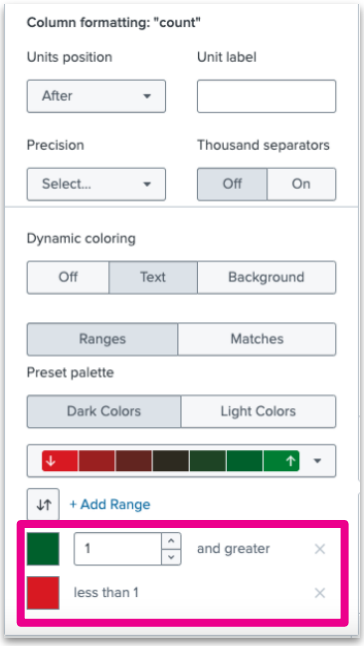
Exercise 6 – Color table columns by hidden values

Description

Color table columns based on values in hidden columns using Dynamic Options Syntax (DOS). You do not need to create a new table, you will use the table that is already in your dashboard from the conversion.

Steps

Apply coloring to the 'count' column



1. Select the Purchased table, navigate to **Color and style,** and under **Column-specific formatting,** add the "count" column
2. Select the pencil icon next to "count - number" and under **Dynamic coloring**, select **Text**.
3. Configure two ranges:
    a. **Less than 1** is **red**
    b. **1 or greater** is **green**

Update the DOS to use _has_stock

4. Open the **Code** section at the bottom of the configuration panel or find the table's source code in the full source code editor

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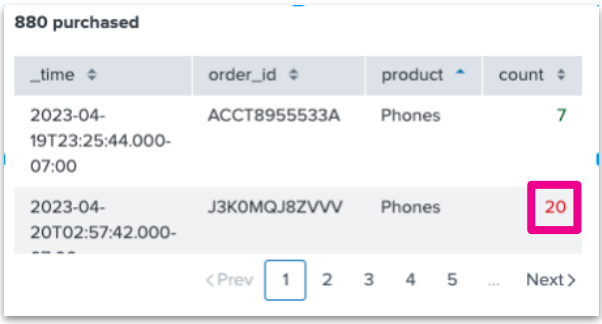
In source, under "options" > "columnFormat" > "count" > "rowColors", replace `seriesByName(\"count\")` with `seriesByName(\"_has_stock\")`

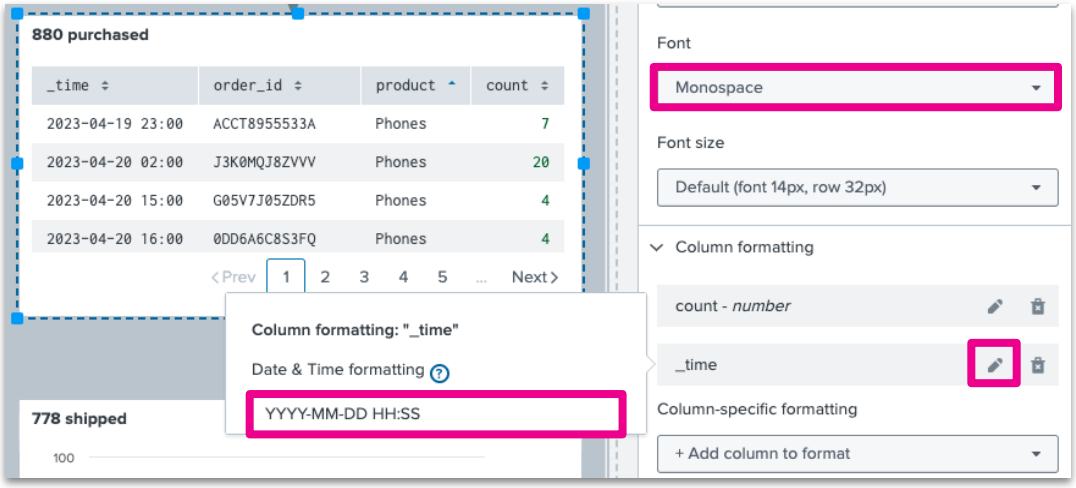
```
"options": {
    "columnFormat": {
        "count": {
            "data": "> table | seriesByName(\"count\") | formatByType(countColumnFormatEditorConfig)",
            "rowColors": "> table | seriesByName(\"_has_stock\") | rangeValue(countRowColorsEditorConfig)"
        },
```

Your table should now have values in count that are red:



Finish formatting the table

5. Under **Color and style** change **Font** to "Monospace"
6. Under **Column-specific formatting**, select _time and apply the format: **YYYY-MM-DD HH:SS**



Note: As a best practice, configure as much in the UI as possible first before modifying the source code.

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Exercise 7 – Add secondary data sources to a line chart

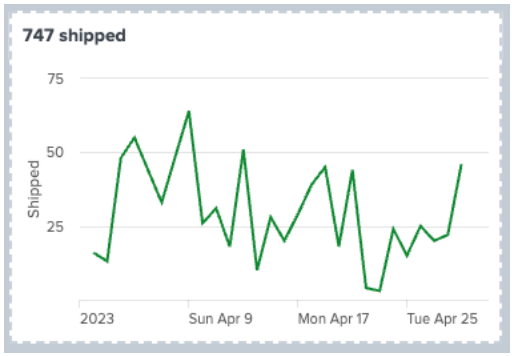
Description

Add annotations and overlay target thresholds to the Shipped line chart using Dynamic Options Syntax (DOS)

Steps

Beautify the Shipped line chart

1. Under **Data display**, change Null value display to "**Connect**"
2. Under **Color and style**, add a series to **Series color by field name**. Select the field name **count** and apply the color **#118832**
3. Under **Legend** change **Legend display** to "**Off**"
4. Under **X-axis grid and labels**, deselect **Axis title**, and change **Number of time label parts** to 1
5. Under **Y-axis grid and labels**, specify **Axis title text** as "**Shipped**"



Add an annotation data source

6. Select the line chart. Under **Data sources**, select **+ Set up annotation data source**
7. Create a new chain search:
    a. Name: **Order events over time**
    b. Parent search: **ds_orders_over_time**
    c. Chain SPL:

```
| where count>60 | eval label="Big sale"
```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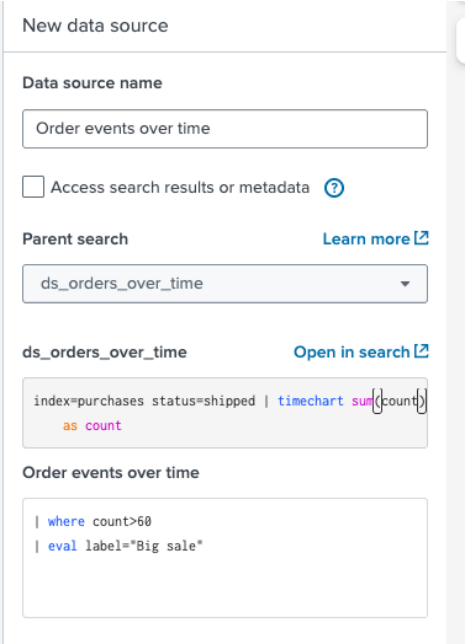
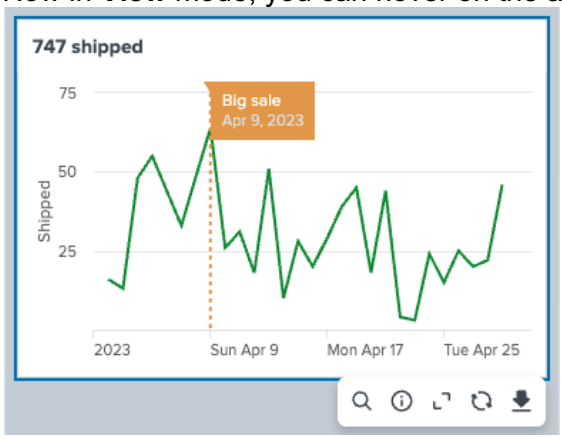


Click on **Apply and close.**

Configure the chart annotation

8. Under **Data configurations,** select **Annotation x** to be "**_time (time)**"
9. Under **Data configurations,** select **Annotation labels** to be "**label (string)**"

Now in **View** mode, you can hover on the annotation to see the label.



Create a search for "target" orders

10. Navigate to the **Data source overview**

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11. Create a new chain search:
    a. Name: **Orders target**
    b. Parent search: **ds_orders_over_time**
    c. Chain SPL:

```
| eval target=50
```

12. Open the code editor and copy the data source ID
13. Click on **Apply and lose.**

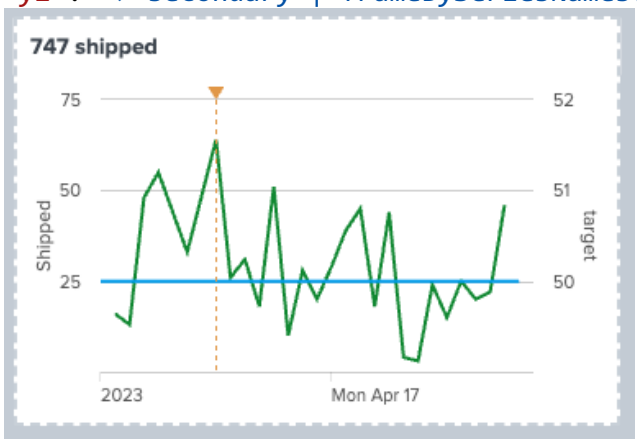
Use DOS to add a secondary data source

14. Select the line chart and open the code editor
15. Under **"dataSources"** add the ID you just copied from the last step:

```
"secondary": "<your ID>"
```

16. Under **"options"** add:

```
"y2": "> secondary | frameBySeriesNames('target')",
```



Note: Learn more about how to write and modify DOS by visiting our [documentation](#).

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Exercise 8 – Color map bubbles

Description

Color map bubbles based on anomalous behavior using Dynamic Options Syntax (DOS)

Steps

Search for abnormal activity

1. Update the map data source to create a new field to designate abnormal activity by appending:

```
| fillnull
| eval abnormal_activity=if(customers > credit_cards, 1, 0)
```

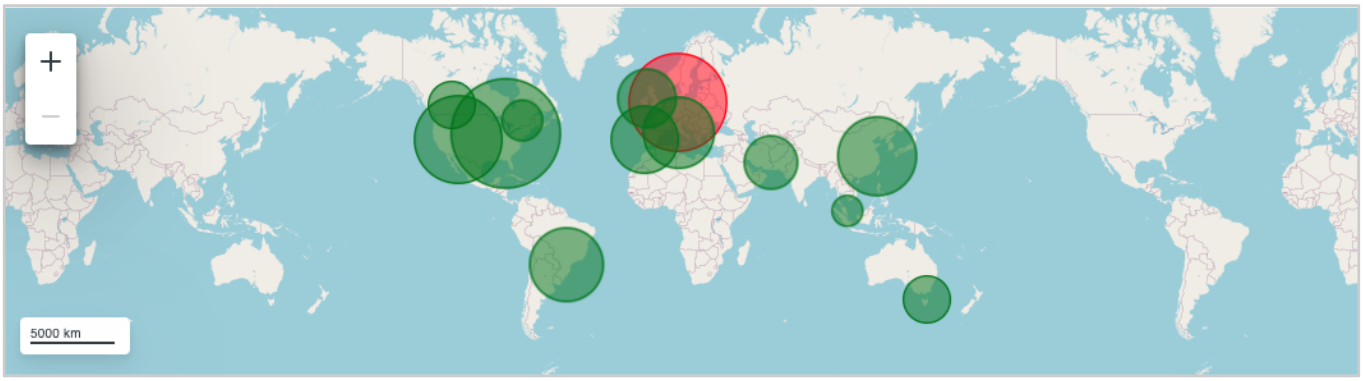
2. Click on **Apply and close**

3. Select the map and open the **Code** section in the configuration panel or find the map code in the full source code editor. Under **"context"** create a section called **thresholdConfig**:

```
"context": {
        "thresholdConfig": [
                {
                        "to": 1,
                        "value": "green"
                },
                {
                        "from": 1,
                        "value": "red"
                }
        ]
}
```

4. Under **"options"** under **"layers"** add the following:

```
"dataColors": "> primary | seriesByName('abnormal_activity') | rangeValue(thresholdConfig)",
```



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Exercise 9 – Add custom SVGs

Description

Add custom SVGs to your dashboard, which dynamically respond to search results

Steps

Create the inventory data source

1. Create a new search that will return what % of product is left in inventory:

    a. Name**: Inventory totals**

    b. SPL:

```
| makeresults count=1
| eval inventory_tablets=400
| eval inventory_phones=400
| eval inventory_robots=250
| eval inventory_rockets=250
| eval current_tablets=
  (inventory_tablets-$ds_purchases_by_product:result.Tablets$)/inventory_tablets*100
| eval current_phones=(inventory_phones-
$ds_purchases_by_product:result.Phones$)/inventory_phones*100
| eval current_robots=(inventory_robots-
$ds_purchases_by_product:result.Robots$)/inventory_robots*100
| eval current_rockets=
  (inventory_rockets-$ds_purchases_by_product:result.Rockets$)/inventory_rockets*100
| table _time current_tablets current_phones current_robots current_rockets
```

    c. Check the box that says **"Access search results or metadata"**

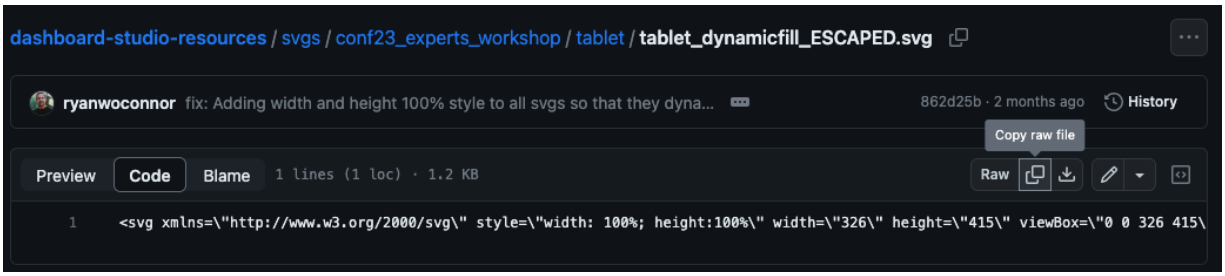
    Click on **Apply and close**

2. Edit the **ds_purchases_by_product** data source and check the **"Access search results or metadata"** box

    Click on **Apply and close**

Copy the SVG definition

3. Copy the raw file for the Tablet SVG here



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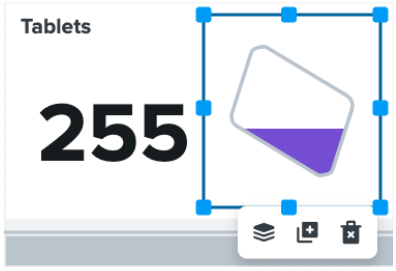
Add an SVG to your dashboard

4. Add a **Choropleth SVG** and place it next to a single value KPI
5. When prompted to select a data source, select "**Cancel**"
6. Open the Code editor and under **"options"**, add:

```
"svg": "<copied file>”
```



7. **Repeat these steps** for the remaining products:
    a. Github links: Phone, Robot and Rocket

Note: You can find many resources and free tools online for creating custom SVGs.

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Exercise 10 – Configure additional interactions

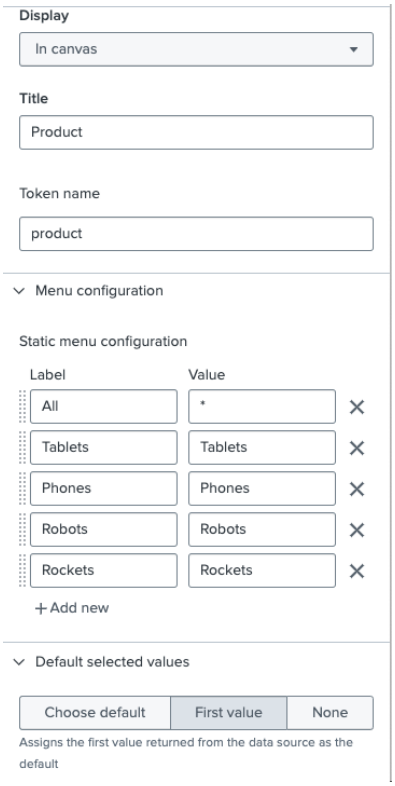
Description

Configure a "Set token on click" interaction and Input to share the same token. Set up multiple interactions on one visualization.

Steps

Filter the map by product

1. Add a dropdown input
2. Under **Display**, select **In canvas**
3. Reposition and resize the dropdown to be next to the Purchase activity custom map label
    a. Title: **Product**
    b. Token name: **product**
    c. Menu items - Label (value)
        i. **All (*)**
        ii. **Tablets**
        iii. **Phones**
        iv. **Robots**
        v. **Rockets**
    d. Default selected values: **First value**



4. Select the map

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5. Edit the **Purchase activity search**
6. Add **product=$product$** to the first pipe
7. Select **Apply and close**
8. Select different products from the dropdown to see the map update

Configure interactions to set the product filter

1. Select the **Tablets** single value
2. Under Interactions, select **+ Add interaction**
3. Under **On click**, select **Set tokens**
   a. Token name: **product**
   b. Token value: **name**
4. Select **Apply**
5. Repeat for Phones, Robots, and Rockets
6. Save your dashboard and go to View mode. Select one of the product KPIs and notice the Product dropdown and map update.

Set up additional interactions

1. Back in **Edit** mode, select the **Tablets** KPI**.**
2. Under **Interactions**, select **+ Add interaction**.
3. Under **On click**, select **Link to custom URL**.
   - In the **URL** field, enter **https://www.google.com/search?q=$product$**.
   - Check the box to **Open in a new tab**.
4. Select **Apply**.
5. Save your dashboard and go to **View** mode. Select the **Tablets** KPI to see the **Product** dropdown and map update, and a redirection modal prompt navigation to Google.

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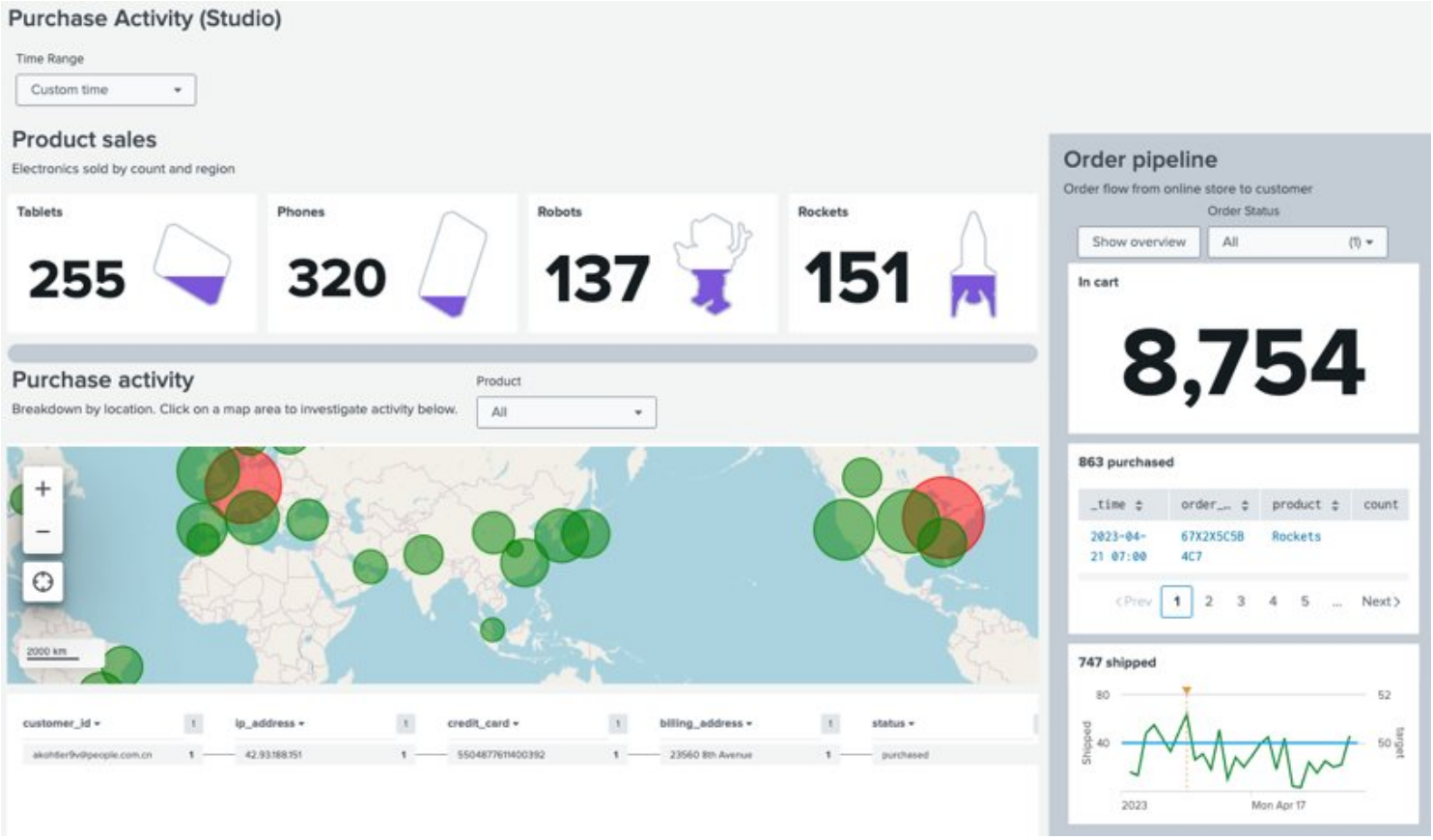
Your dashboard now looks like this!



Exercise 11 – Design tips for finish touches

Description

Learn best practices for designing a dashboard that effectively communicates insights.

Steps

1. Check that objects on your dashboard are aligned when possible.
2. Check that objects are spaced evenly.
3. Check for consistency:
    - Use the same color palette when possible.
    - Use the same casing in your labels.

Note: Check out our resources on [Dashboard Design Best Practices] and [Visualization Choices and Configurations.]

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